

CONTACT INFORMATION	Goethe University Frankfurt Theodor-W.-Adorno-Platz 4 Frankfurt am Main, 60313 Germany	Phone: +49 162 1552547 E-mail: zhuokun.liu@econ.uni-frankfurt.de Website: zhuokun-liu.com
RESEARCH FIELDS	Behavioral and Experimental Economics	
CURRENT POSITION	Research Assistant Chair of Applied Microeconomics (Prof. Dr. Ferdinand von Siemens) Goethe University Frankfurt	2021 –
AFFILIATIONS	Frankfurt Laboratory for Experimental Economic Research (FLEX)	2021 –
EDUCATION	Goethe University Frankfurt Ph.D. in Economics M.Sc. in Quantitative Economics	(Expected) 2026 2025
	Jacobs University Bremen B.A. in International Business Administration	2019
	Rice University Visiting Undergraduate	2018
WORKING PAPERS	Stereotypes and Memory (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung) Imperfect memory can sustain widely held stereotypes that are inaccurate. To establish causal evidence, we conduct an online experiment where subjects grade a gender-stereotyped quiz for a class of students and later predict their performances on a similar quiz. We vary (1) reliance on memory by manipulating access to grading records and (2) the class with different gender performance gap. We find that stereotypes – perceived gender performance gaps – persist more when subjects rely on memory, but only when the true performance contradicts stereotypes. This result holds only for group-level, but not for individual-level assessments. Then, we extend the standard Bayesian framework with imperfect memory and find evidence of <i>memory attenuation</i> : reliance on memory substantially reduces how accurately individuals incorporate previously observed performance into their beliefs.	
	Communication and the Polarization of Trust Attitudes (with Ferdinand von Siemens) Given the critical role of generalized trust in the functioning of both public and private organizations, it is important to better understand the factors driving the substantial differences in trust across states, regions, and organizations. Group polarization theory suggests that communication might foster consensus within, while increasing differences across social groups. To test this argument, we conduct an online experiment in which some participants communicate before playing separate trust games. Participants only communicate with other participants in the same role – trustors talk with other trustors. Our results show that communication reduces the variation in trust within, while increasing trust differences between the chat groups, thus leading to a polarization of trust cultures. We further find that groups that develop strong positive trust cultures focus in their discussions on both moral principles and self-interest.	
WORK IN PROGRESS	Misleading Graphs	

GRANTS AND AWARDS	The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences	
	Co-PI (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung), Research grant — 128,272 SEK	2025
	Goethe University Frankfurt	
	Research grant (VFF Förderung) — 800 EUR	2025
	Research grant (Forschungstopf) — 3,200 EUR	2025
	Travel grant (Forschungstopf)	2024
	Research grant (Forschungstopf) — 3,240 EUR	2023
	Research grant (VFF Förderung) — 800 EUR	2023
	The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE	
	Co-PI (with Huen Tat Au-Yeung), Research grant — 3,000 EUR	2024
SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (INCLUDING SCHEDULED)	Jacobs University Bremen	
	Study Abroad Scholarship	2018
	2025	
	<i>Conferences:</i>	
	17 th Nordic Conference in Behavioral and Experimental Economics (Stavanger)	
	Science of Decision Making Conference (Chengdu)	
	Behavioral, Experimental and Theoretical Economics Conference (Beijing)	
	Economic Science Association World Meeting (Beijing)	
	Young Economists' Meeting (Brno)	
	<i>Seminars:</i>	
TEACHING	Jinan University (Guangzhou)	
	Central University of Finance and Economics (Beijing)	
	2024	
	<i>Conferences:</i>	
	Verona Experimental Meeting (Verona)	
	13 th Southern Europe Experimental Team's Meeting (Málaga)	
	Goethe University Frankfurt	
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	
	• Fundamentals of Microeconomics (M.Sc.)	Winter 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
	• Behavioral Organizational Economics (B.Sc. Seminar)	Winter 2025
	• The Economics of Social Media (M.Sc. Seminar)	Winter 2022, 2023, 2024
	• Microeconomics 2 (B.Sc.)	Summer 2024
	• Decision Making in Markets and Organizations (B.Sc.)	Summer 2023
	• Organizational Economics (M.Sc.)	Summer 2021, 2022
	• Advanced Topics in Experimental Organizational Economics (M.Sc. Seminar)	Winter 2021
	<i>Thesis Supervisor</i>	
	• Bachelor Thesis (x15)	
	• Master Thesis (x10)	

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES	Applied Microeconomics and Organization Seminar Co-organizer, Goethe University Frankfurt	2023 –
	Management and Microeconomics Brown Bag Seminar Organizer, Goethe University Frankfurt	2022 –
	Annual Meeting of the Committee for Organizational Economics Co-organizer, Frankfurt	2022
TECHNICAL SKILLS	L ^A T _E X, ORSEE, oTree, Python, Stata	
LANGUAGES	English (fluent), Chinese (native), German (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate)	
PERSONAL INFORMATION	Born in 1999 Citizenship: Chinese, German permanent resident (Niederlassungserlaubnis)	
REFERENCES	Ferdinand von Siemens (Main advisor) Goethe University Frankfurt Theodor-W.-Adorno-Platz 4 60313 Frankfurt am Main vonsiemens@econ.uni-frankfurt.de	Frederik Schwerter Frankfurt School of Finance and Management Adickesallee 32-34 60322 Frankfurt am Main f.schwerter@fs.de